

Westlake Hills & Rollingwood: Complete Buyer's Guide to Austin's Premier School District

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Eanes ISD is the defining asset of Westlake Hills and Rollingwood — and it shapes everything from home prices to resale dynamics. A complete guide for buyers considering Austin's most consistently desirable school district.

No area in the Austin real estate market is referenced more often and understood less deeply than Westlake Hills and Rollingwood.

The shorthand — 'Westlake' — covers a geography and a school district that buyers from outside Austin often conflate with a single neighborhood. In practice, Westlake Hills is an incorporated city with its own municipal government within Travis County. Rollingwood is a separate incorporated city adjacent to it. Both lie entirely within Eanes Independent School District, which is the defining feature — and the primary driver of value — for every property in the area.

Understanding Westlake Hills and Rollingwood is, at its core, understanding what makes Eanes ISD worth what it costs to live in it — and what the specific properties within that district look like at different price points.

Eanes ISD: The District That Defines the Market

Eanes Independent School District serves Westlake Hills, Rollingwood, and a small portion of the Bee Cave community in far west Austin. It is consistently rated one of the top school districts in Texas and routinely appears on national lists of the best public school systems in the country.

Westlake High School — the district's single high school — consistently produces among the highest SAT and ACT scores of any large public high school in Texas. The district's graduation rate exceeds 99%, and a significant percentage of graduates enroll in four-year universities.

At the elementary level, Eanes ISD operates three schools: Forest Trail, Valley View, and Bridge Point. Each serves a specific attendance zone within the district. All three are well-regarded and feed into West Ridge Middle School and ultimately Westlake High. Buyers should verify which elementary

serves a specific address — and not assume based on the neighborhood name.

The Eanes ISD premium in home prices is real and documented. Comparable homes — same size, same condition, same distance from downtown — trade at 20 to 35% more inside Eanes ISD than just outside its boundaries. For buyers with school-age children, that premium is frequently justified. For buyers without school priorities, other Austin micro-markets offer better value at lower price points.

What Westlake Hills Looks Like: Property Types and Price Ranges

Westlake Hills is a residential city of approximately 3,200 residents, incorporated into its own municipal structure within Travis County. It has its own city government, permitting, and development standards more restrictive than the City of Austin — part of what preserves neighborhood character and limits density.

Most residential development follows a hillside pattern — homes built on sloped terrain with significant elevation changes from street to entry and views in multiple directions. Architectural styles range from mid-century ranch homes on generous lots to contemporary and transitional construction on infill sites.

Entry-level Westlake Hills properties — typically older ranch-style homes with original finishes — start around \$850,000 to \$1,100,000. Mid-range properties — updated homes of 2,500 to 3,500 square feet with privacy and views — range from \$1,100,000 to \$2,000,000. Architecturally significant properties on premium lots can reach \$3,000,000 to \$5,000,000 or more.

Rollingwood: The More Accessible Entry Point

Rollingwood is a smaller city adjacent to Westlake Hills — also entirely within Eanes ISD — that attracts buyers who want the school district at a lower price point. Rollingwood lots are generally flatter, closer to Austin's urban core, and slightly more modest in scale than the hillside properties defining much of Westlake Hills.

Rollingwood properties in 2026 typically range from \$900,000 to \$1,500,000 depending on size, condition, and lot. Because Rollingwood sits closer to Mopac and the urban core, commute times to downtown Austin are generally shorter than for properties farther into Westlake Hills proper.

For buyers who want Eanes ISD access at the lower end of the district's price range, Rollingwood is the most common entry point. For buyers prioritizing view lots, privacy, and hill country character, moving farther into Westlake Hills makes sense despite the additional cost.

Commute from Westlake to Downtown Austin

Westlake Hills and Rollingwood are west of downtown Austin, separated by Mopac (Loop 1) and the Hill Country terrain. Commute realities vary significantly by specific location within the area.

Rollingwood to downtown at 8am: approximately 20 to 30 minutes via Mopac, depending on conditions. At 10am, the same drive takes 12 to 18 minutes. Properties near the Mopac and Bee Caves intersection are among the most commute-convenient in the Eanes ISD area.

Deeper Westlake Hills — properties on Westlake Drive, Rob Roy Road, or in higher-elevation sections — can add 10 to 20 minutes to downtown commute times at peak hours. Many Westlake Hills internal roads are two-lane; this creates time variability that buyers accustomed to multi-lane highways underestimate.

Buyers who work at the Domain or the 183 Tech Corridor face a more complex commute from Westlake Hills, typically routing north via Mopac. For this buyer profile, north Austin neighborhoods often represent a more commute-efficient choice.

Lifestyle in Westlake Hills and Rollingwood

Westlake Hills and Rollingwood are residential in a way that the denser parts of Austin are not. There are no significant commercial strips within the residential core, no through-traffic corridors, and very little of the pedestrian activity that defines South Congress or East Austin.

That is largely the point. Buyers who choose Westlake are explicitly choosing a quieter residential pace — oriented around backyards, cul-de-sacs, neighborhood pools, and school activities rather than walkable restaurants and bars.

Outdoor recreation is accessible: Barton Creek Greenbelt entry points are nearby, Lake Austin is reachable by car, and Loop 360 connects to parks and trails. The lifestyle is car-dependent, and residents accept that trade-off in exchange for school access and residential character.

Commercial amenities are anchored by Davenport Village at Loop 360 and Walsh Tarlton — home to a Central Market, restaurants, and retail. The 360 Overlook and Bee Caves Road corridor provide additional options.

Who Buys in Westlake Hills and Rollingwood

The most common buyer is a family relocating to Austin — often from California, the Pacific Northwest, or another high-income-tax state — with school-age children and household income above \$250,000, purchasing in the \$1,200,000 to \$2,500,000 range.

A secondary profile is the established Austin family doing a move-up purchase — trading a smaller home in Barton Hills or 78704 for more space and Eanes ISD access as children reach elementary school age.

Investor buyers are present but less dominant than in urban Austin neighborhoods. The rental market in Westlake Hills and Rollingwood is thinner — this market is driven by owner-occupants, not renters.

Resale Dynamics: Why Westlake Holds Value

Westlake Hills and Rollingwood have one of the most defensible resale profiles in the Austin market. Properties within Eanes ISD do not discount significantly even in broader market downturns — the driver of demand, school access, is not correlated with tech employment cycles or interest rate sensitivity the way other Austin micro-markets are.

The family buyer pool that drives Westlake demand is relatively recession-resistant. High earners relocating from coastal metros continue arriving in Austin across economic cycles because the income tax savings remain compelling regardless of interest rate conditions.

Supply is constrained — Westlake Hills is largely built out, and Rollingwood has very limited vacant land. New inventory is almost exclusively teardown-and-rebuild, which reinforces price floors throughout the district.

What Buyers Should Know Before Making an Offer

First: verify the specific elementary school assignment for any address before making an offer. All Westlake Hills and Rollingwood properties fall within Eanes ISD, but the elementary assignment varies by address. Use the Eanes ISD address lookup tool — do not assume based on neighborhood name.

Second: septic systems are common in Westlake Hills, particularly for hillside properties not connected to the municipal sewer system. Septic inspection, capacity verification, and maintenance history are important due diligence items.

Third: lot topography matters significantly. A large lot that is 80% slope provides very different lifestyle value than a flat lot of the same nominal size. Walk the lot and evaluate usable outdoor space specifically.

Fourth: deed restrictions in some Westlake Hills sections add a layer to renovation and construction planning. Understanding which restrictions apply requires a title review — particularly relevant for buyers planning significant additions or rebuilds.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What is the best school district in Austin, Texas?

Eanes ISD — serving Westlake Hills and Rollingwood — is widely considered the top school district in the Austin metro and consistently ranks among the best in Texas. Westlake High School produces among the highest test scores of any large public high school in Texas. Homes within Eanes ISD trade at a documented 20-35% premium over comparable homes just outside district boundaries.

How much do homes cost in Westlake Hills, Austin?

Home prices in Westlake Hills in 2026 range from \$850,000 to \$1,100,000 for entry-level properties, \$1,100,000 to \$2,000,000 for mid-range updated homes, and \$3,000,000 to \$5,000,000+ for architecturally significant properties on premium lots. Rollingwood typically ranges from \$900,000 to \$1,500,000 and offers the most accessible entry point into the school district.

What is Rollingwood, Texas known for?

Rollingwood is a small incorporated city adjacent to Westlake Hills, known primarily for its location within Eanes ISD — one of Texas's top school districts — combined with flatter terrain and a slightly lower price point than deeper Westlake Hills properties. Its proximity to Mopac makes it one of the more commute-convenient addresses in the Eanes district, typically 20 to 30 minutes to downtown Austin at peak hours.

How far is Westlake Hills from downtown Austin?

Westlake Hills is approximately 5 to 8 miles from downtown Austin depending on the specific location. Rollingwood is slightly closer. Commute times from Rollingwood run 20 to 30 minutes at peak hours and 12 to 18 minutes during off-peak times. Properties deeper in Westlake Hills can add 10 to 20 minutes to peak-hour commutes.

Is Westlake Hills worth the price premium in Austin?

For families with school-age children, yes — Eanes ISD's documented performance advantage produces school access buyers pay 20-35% above comparable non-Eanes properties to secure. For buyers without school priorities, other Austin micro-markets offer comparable lifestyle at lower price points. The resale case for Westlake Hills is among the strongest in the Austin market.